

YACHATDAC

Wonder — Guesting on Country

GUESTING ON COUNTRY

You will feel it before anyone explains it.

An escarpment full of caves and blowholes, a story wall older than almost anything people have kept, and a sky with nothing in the way of it. Turraburra is met on foot, with the people who belong to it.

THE FIRST NIGHT

The dark out here still has stars in it.

No town glow, no traffic. When the fire burns down the sky comes all the way to the ground, and the stars that have been read from this Country for tens of thousands of years are just there, close enough to feel crowded by.

People go quiet. Most say it is the part they were not expecting.

WHY WE SAY GUESTING

You'll be hosted, not toured.

We call this guesting on Country because that is what it is. You are welcomed on by the people who belong to this Country, into their care and to their fire.

Guests get looked after. Guests also get trusted with more than a passing visitor would.

ON COUNTRY

Country sets the days, not a timetable.

What happens while you are here depends on the season, the weather, and what Country asks for that week. Rain the night before, and the morning might go to a cool burn. Seed on the grasses, and you will be out collecting it. None of it is put on for visitors — you join what is already underway, which is why no two groups get the same days.

THE ESCARPMENT

Walking the sites

A labyrinth of weathered caves and blowholes runs along the edge of the Aramac Range. Inside is the story wall — marked at least 55,000 years ago, and still being read.

NATIVE FOODS

Harvesting on Country

The scrub that looked empty on the drive in turns out to be full of food — herbs, fruits, seeds, nuts. You learn to see it, and then you cannot unsee it.

FIRST LIGHT

The oldest sunrise

Morning comes up over the escarpment the way it has here for longer than there have been words for it. Worth the early start.

CARING FOR COUNTRY

Hands in the work

Cool burns, seed collecting, bringing a spring back. Hands in, if you would like — most people find they want to be.

YOUR HOSTS

You are with the people whose Country this is.

Suzanne, Graham and the Iningai Rangers host every group themselves. This is the same Country they work every week — the fences, the burns, the springs. You are in their company the whole time you are here.

BEFORE YOU COME

Small groups. Swags. A long way from town.

Turraburra sits 120km north of Barcaldine in Central Western Queensland, 8,870 hectares of it. You will camp — swag or tent, meals shared, fire at night. Groups stay small on purpose, so it stays quiet.

Dates move with the seasons and with the people hosting you, so they are arranged with you directly rather than picked off a list. Tell us who is coming and roughly when, and we will find the right time.

Register your interest

FROM COUNTRY

Stories from out here.

[Placeholder — three posts, editor-selected from the Wonder collection]

[IMAGE] [Story title] [One-line excerpt] Read more →	[IMAGE] [Story title] [One-line excerpt] Read more →	[IMAGE] [Story title] [One-line excerpt] Read more →
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